

CHANGE MANAGEMENT POLICY

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Prepared by	Designation
Kalpana J	Project Manager
Approved by	Designation
Gayathri V	Chief Information Security Officer

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Revision History

#	Version	Release Date	Description of the Change	Created/ Modified by	Approved by
1	1.0	16-May-2024	Initial	Kalpana J	Gayathri

Review History

#	Version	Review Date	Description	Created/ Modified by	Reviewed by
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1. Purpose

The purpose of this Change Management Policy is to establish a structured and standardized approach to managing changes within our organization. This policy ensures that all changes to software systems, infrastructure, and processes are properly evaluated, approved, documented, implemented, and reviewed. By doing so, we aim to minimize disruptions, mitigate risks, and maintain the quality and stability of our solutions for clients.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all software systems, applications, infrastructure, and related processes that are managed by the company, including:

- Software development and deployment
- Infrastructure changes (e.g., hardware, network configurations)
- Process changes (e.g., workflows, business operations)
- Security updates and patches

The policy is relevant to all teams involved in the development, testing, deployment, and maintenance of software solutions, including developers, testers, project managers, IT support, and any other relevant stakeholders.

3. Change Categories

Changes will be classified into the following categories based on their impact and complexity:

- **Standard Changes:** Routine and low-risk changes that follow a predefined procedure (e.g., software patch updates, minor feature enhancements).
- **Minor Changes:** Low to medium impact changes that do not significantly affect the overall system or customer experience.
- **Major Changes:** High-impact changes that could affect the functionality or stability of software products, infrastructure, or business operations.
- **Emergency Changes:** Unplanned changes made in response to critical issues (e.g., system outages, security vulnerabilities) that require immediate action.

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4. Change Management Process

The change management process follows a structured flow from request initiation to closure:

Step 1: Change Request Submission

- Any team member may submit a change request (CR) through the Change Request System or ticketing platform.
- The request should include details such as the type of change, reasons for the change, potential impacts, and proposed timelines.

Step 2: Change Evaluation & Impact Assessment

- The Change Advisory Board (CAB) will assess the change based on its potential impact, risk, cost, and resources needed.
- For major and emergency changes, risk assessments will be conducted to identify possible issues that may arise.

Step 3: Change Approval

- All standard changes should be pre-approved as part of the standard operating procedures.
- Minor changes must be reviewed and approved by relevant stakeholders (e.g., project managers, team leads).
- Major and emergency changes require approval from the CAB, ensuring senior management and stakeholders are informed.

Step 4: Planning and Implementation

- Once approved, a detailed plan will be created that outlines the timeline, resources, and steps for implementing the change.
- Testing and validation will occur in a controlled environment before deployment to ensure minimal disruption to production systems.

Step 5: Change Implementation

- Implementation is carried out according to the plan.
- If the change is a major or emergency change, it will be rolled out in stages or with appropriate rollback procedures in place to avoid system-wide disruptions.

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Step 6: Post-Implementation Review

- After implementing the change, the team will conduct a post-implementation review (PIR) to assess its effectiveness and ensure no unforeseen issues have occurred.
- The PIR will include feedback from relevant stakeholders, including customers (if applicable), and document lessons learned.

Step 7: Change Closure and Documentation

- The change is formally closed after the successful review, and all associated documentation is updated, including any knowledge articles or operational procedures affected by the change.
- The Change Request System will be updated to reflect the completion of the change and any further actions taken.

5. Roles and Responsibilities

Change Advisory Board (CAB)

- Reviews, approves, and evaluates all major and emergency changes.
- Provides oversight and ensures that the change management process is being followed.

Change Owner

- Responsible for the overall success of the change, including submission, approval, implementation, and post-implementation review.

Development and IT Support Teams

- Execute the change as per the plan.
- Communicate with stakeholders regarding change status and any issues encountered.

Project Managers

- Coordinate the planning and execution of changes related to project deliverables.
- Ensure that the necessary resources are available for smooth implementation.

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Quality Assurance (QA) Team

- Conducts testing for changes to ensure that there are no negative impacts on software functionality, security, or performance.

6. Change Communication

Clear and timely communication is critical to ensuring all stakeholders are informed of changes and their potential impact. The following communication practices will be observed:

- Internal Notifications: Teams affected by the change (e.g., development, operations, QA) will be notified in advance.
- External Notifications: For changes impacting customers (e.g., new software releases, updates), communication will be sent to the relevant clients or end-users.
- Emergency Changes: In case of emergency changes, immediate communication will be made to relevant teams, customers (if applicable), and management.

7. Change Records and Documentation

All changes will be properly documented to provide traceability and accountability. This includes:

- Change Request Form
- Change Evaluation and Impact Assessment Report
- Approval Records
- Implementation Plan and Timeline
- Post-Implementation Review Report

These records will be stored in the organization's central documentation repository and reviewed periodically.

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8. Compliance and Auditing

The change management process will be subject to regular audits to ensure compliance with internal policies and external regulatory requirements (if applicable). Any deviations from the approved procedures or poor implementation practices will be reviewed and addressed.

9. Continuous Improvement

This Change Management Policy will be reviewed and improved periodically to ensure that it remains effective, efficient, and aligned with industry best practices. Feedback from stakeholders will be considered during these reviews to adapt the policy to evolving organizational needs.

10. References

- ISO 20000 (IT Service Management)
- ITIL (Information Technology Infrastructure Library)
- Industry best practices for change management